Ikshvaku contacts with Rome, it is made of brick and stone slabs, and has a covered pavilion at the top with named seats reserved for the royalty and the nobles. (Experts claim that the amphitheatre's pit, 16 m x 14 m, was designed to produce good acoustics.) It is likely used for public debates, religious discourses, music and theatre acts, and rip-roaring wrestling contests, the taste for which is evident even in the sculpture of Vijayapuri. Right above the amphitheatre on the hill is a temple with a human-sized seated figure of the Buddhist goddess Hariti, protector of children. This temple's precincts afford a panoramic view of the amphitheatre and the city.



Figure 8. Amphitheatre of Vijayapuri

The Rise of Vijayapuri

In late second century CE, Nagarjunakonda Valley had a small settlement called Sriparvata. An outpost of the Satavahana Empire, whose capital was at Amravathi, 140 km away, Sriparvata was home to a community of